



Figure 1: A preview of graphs generated by Cacti



Figure 2: Create Device page of Cacti

```
net-snmp-config --create-snmpv3-user -X \
<passphrase> -a <password> <username>
```

Now, in order to check whether your SNMP set-up is working or not, you can use a tool called `snmpwalk` as follows:

```
snmpwalk -v <version_number> -c \
<community> <hostname/ip_address>
```

If this fails, you need to verify whether the `snmpd` service is running and your firewall is not blocking port 161 on the desired host.

Step 2—Configure PHP: You will need to uncomment/add the following lines to your `php.ini` file, if your distribution hasn't done it automatically:

```
extension_dir = /etc/php.d
;Enable mysql extension module
extension=mysql.so
;Enable snmp extension module
extension=snmp.so
session.save_path=/tmp
file_uploads = On
```

Step 3—Configure Apache: Configure Apache Web

server to serve Cacti through your browser. Edit your `/etc/apache2/httpd.conf` file to add the following line:

```
Include conf.d/*.conf
```

Add the following lines to `/etc/httpd/conf.d/php.conf` file:

```
LoadModule php5_module modules/libphp5.so
AddHandler php5-script .php
AddType text/html .php
DirectoryIndex index.php
```

Restart the `apache` service to see the changes.

Note that the paths of the above Apache config files may vary from distro to distro. So, just in case you are unable to locate these files, consult your distribution documentation to find where the Apache configuration files are stored.

If your distribution installs Cacti to `/usr/share/cacti`, you can use `vhst` to point to Cacti directory. Please check the Apache documentation on `vhst` for more information at <http://httpd.apache.org/docs/2.0/vhosts/> for version 2.0

Step 4—Configure MySQL: Now, check whether your MySQL service is running (if not, start it). Create a database and a MySQL user for Cacti as follows:

```
CREATE DATABASE <db_name>;
```

```
GRANT ALL ON <db_name>.* ON <db_user>@'<hostname>' IDENTIFIED
BY <password>;
FLUSH PRIVILEGES;
```

Step 5—Configure and Install Cacti: If you have downloaded a tarball of Cacti from the website, untar it as follows:

```
tar xzvf cacti-<version>.tar.gz
```

Edit the configuration files to provide database information. Cacti is installed in `/usr/share/cacti` for most RPM-based distributions:

```
$EDITOR <path_to_cacti>/includes/config.php
$database_type = "mysql";
$database_default = "<db_name>";
$database_hostname = "<hostname>";
$database_username = "<db_user>";
$database_password = "<password>";
```

Now set permission for the Cacti user to access the `rra/` and `log/` directories. This step is needed to enable proper logging and creation of graphs:

```
cd <path_to_cacti>
chown -R <cacti_user> rra/ log/
```